SOUNDLINE

SCHOOL · NORTH SHORE, LONG ISLAND

A new private middle school · Grades 6–8 · Opening September 2027

Soundline School is a new middle school.

And it is not school as usual.

Every morning there are two hours of math, reading and writing, at your child's own level. The rest of the day is classes, labs and real projects. Every adult in the building knows your kid. Soundline opens in September 2027 on Long Island's North Shore, most likely in Port Jefferson Station.

Morning

8:30 to 10:30 · math, reading and writing. We call it practice.

The rest of the day

10:30 to 3:00 · classes, science lab and a long project. We call it making.

After school

To 5:30, if you need it. We call it Extended Day.

Depth with direction.

WHY SOUNDLINE

What makes this school different.

2 hours

of math, reading and writing, every morning

Each child works at their own level, with a guide (our word for a teacher) at the table. A kid who is ahead moves ahead. A kid who is behind gets caught up. Nobody waits, and nobody gets left.

4 hours

of classes, labs and projects, every day

Science lab, history, books, art and music. Every six weeks your child finishes a real project and shows it to the people it was made for.

Every adult

knows your kid

There are ten to twelve students in a grade. One adult stays with your child for all three years, and knows what they are good at and what is hard for them.

You know your kid. School should too.

If one of these sounds like your house, this school was built for you.

Bored.
They finish early and wait for the class. Here they move on the day they are ready.

Doing fine, and that's all.
Good grades, no spark. Here they build things for real people and explain them out loud.

Behind, and nobody noticed.
Here a guide sits with them every morning, knows exactly what they can't do yet, and works on it with them.

Lost in the crowd.
Here there are ten to twelve kids in a grade, and the same adult looks out for yours for three years.

WHERE THE NAME COMES FROM

Before sonar, sailors dropped a sounding line over the side of the boat. It was a rope with a lead weight on the end, and it told them how deep the water was before they picked a direction. We do the same with your child. First we find out where they really are in each subject, and what they love. Then we pick a direction together.

WHAT STUDENTS LEARN

Nobody knows what work will look like when your child is thirty.

So we teach what will matter no matter what. By the end of eighth grade, a Soundline student can do six things.

01
Learn something hard.
And show they really know it, not just that they sat through it.

02
Make something new.
A video game, a robot, a short film, a song. Finished, on a deadline, for a real person in town.

03
Think it through in writing.
Clear writing is clear thinking. They write every day.

04
Stand up and explain it.
Every six weeks, in front of adults who ask questions. No slides.

05
Do something for their town.
One project a year is for the community they live in.

06
Know what they are good at.
And have a folder of real work that proves it.

New York has decided a diploma should stand for six things a graduate can do, not only test scores. We built the school around those six.

Every six weeks your child adds real work to a folder: something they made, something they explained out loud, and proof that they grew. By eighth grade the folder shows what they can do.

HOW YOU WILL KNOW IT IS WORKING

We test growth three times a year.
Every student takes a test called NWEA MAP in fall, winter and spring. We publish how much the whole school grew, counting every student. No child's score is public. Your child's comes home to you.

You will see the work.
The robot, the performance, and your child explaining how they did it.

We teach AI as a subject.
Kids learn to use it well. It is never allowed to do their thinking for them.

We answer to New York.
We register with the state, and the district reviews what we teach. We are not accredited yet. That starts once we are open.

A DAY HERE

What a school day looks like.

School runs 8:30 to 3:00, Monday to Friday.

8:30 TO 10:30

Math, reading and writing.

We call it practice. Each child works at their own level, with a guide at the table. It is hands-on. The only screen in the room is the guide's.

10:30 TO 3:00

Classes, labs and projects.

We call it making. History, literature and science are taught by a person, with books, not by an app. There is lunch, time outside, and the arts every day.

EVERY SIX WEEKS

Then they show it.

Each project lasts six weeks and is made for a real person in town. At the end your child stands up and explains it. No slides.

A WEEK AT SOUNDLINE

The schedule is the same every week, so the work can change.

Every morning at 10:30 the whole school sits down together with one real problem from town.

MONDAY	**The plan**	At 8:45 each student sets one goal and one plan for the week.
TUESDAY	**Science lab, then projects**	Ninety minutes of hands-on science, written up before they leave the lab. Then everyone works on their project: a video game, a robot, a portrait, a sculpture, a song.
WEDNESDAY	**Books**	The long discussion of the week: a novel, a question, and a paragraph. Every discussion ends in writing.
THURSDAY	**Apprenticeships**	Seventh and eighth graders work alongside an adult who does a job for a living. Sixth graders work on their project.
FRIDAY	**One big build, then the show**	The whole school builds one thing together: a song, a mural, a project for someone in town. At 2:00 students present their work and something is performed. It is usually loud. Families are welcome.

AFTER SCHOOL

Extended Day, 3:00 to 5:30. A lesson at 3:15, then a homework desk until 5:30. It is for five-day students. It costs $330 a month over twelve months, or $297 for Founding Families, and you pay only if you use it.

A TUESDAY

One seventh grader's Tuesday, hour by hour.

This is a Tuesday in September, the way we plan to run it. We follow one student from the door to pickup. There is no name, because our first students start in September 2027.

8:30
ARRIVAL

The door.

The same adult greets them every morning. Bag on the hook, phone in the box, a word about the weekend.

8:45
MORNING MEETING

Fifteen minutes with their guide.

A guide is our word for a teacher. Ten to twelve students meet with the guide who stays with them for three years. Each sets a goal for the day. Today's: pass the check on proportions, and draft a question for science lab.

9:00
PRACTICE · 50 MIN

Math, at their own level.

A student moves to the next skill when they can show a guide they have it, not when the calendar says so. Across the table, a sixth grader is working on a skill this student passed in week one. Beside them, an eighth grader is on one they will reach by winter.

9:50
PRACTICE · 40 MIN

Reading and writing.

Today they read about how ice carved Long Island Sound, because science lab needs it. Then they write two paragraphs. One has to make an argument.

10:30
WHOLE SCHOOL · 30 MIN

Everyone together. Today, math.

Every morning at 10:30 the whole school sits down with one real problem from town and talks it through. We call it seminar. Tuesday is math. One student proves why a shortcut works. This student finds the case where it doesn't, on the fourth try.

11:00
OUTSIDE · 40 MIN

Lunch and outside.

Kids go outside every day, whatever the weather. A guide learns a lot about a student out here.

11:40
SCIENCE LAB · 95 MIN

Building a depth sensor.

They are building a sensor on a line that measures how deep a tank of water is. Today they test it, and the graph bends where it shouldn't. On Friday they explain why, out loud.

1:15
PROJECT TIME · 60 MIN

The six-week project.

We call it a Quest. This is week three of six. The children's librarian asked for an exhibit on how sound travels through water. The group has a plan, forty dollars, and a speaker that won't stay sealed. A guide is in the room and does not fix it for them.

2:15
MUSIC · 45 MIN

The school band.

Everyone plays something. Nobody has to be good yet. This student has the bass part.

3:00
EXTENDED DAY

Home, or Extended Day.

Pickup is at 3:00. Or your child stays: a lesson at 3:15, then a homework desk until 5:30. The project stays at school.

Imagined. Our first students arrive in September 2027.

IS IT A REAL SCHOOL?

Yes, it's a real school.

It is different on purpose. It is still a school, and it answers to New York like any other.

Every subject New York requires.
Math, English, science and history every year, plus art, music, PE and health.

Every adult is background-checked.
Fingerprinted through New York State, with a state and FBI check, before they start.

It continues through high school.
Ninth grade opens in September 2028. Then we add a grade each year through twelfth.

Five days a week.
You enroll your child and that's it. There is no homeschool paperwork. Homeschooling families can come three days a week instead.

We answer to New York.
We register with the state, and the district reviews what we teach. Students take the state tests in the spring. We are not accredited yet. That starts once we are open.

And it is new.
Our first students start in September 2027, so we have no results to show you yet. We can show you the plan, the people, and the day, hour by hour.

WHY IT WORKS

Each part has been studied for decades. Putting them in one school is new.

A child moves on when they have it.
More than a hundred studies show this works better than moving the whole class on a schedule. Students who struggle gain the most.

Long projects raise test scores.
In controlled studies, students who learned through long projects scored higher on state tests than students taught the usual way.

Writing and talking make it stick.
Students remember what they have to write about and explain out loud.

Kids work harder for an adult who knows them.
One close relationship with a teacher is among the strongest predictors of how hard a student tries, and it matters more as kids get older. That is why one adult stays with your child for three years.

The studies, with sources: soundlineschool.com/research.html

ABOUT US

The people starting it.

There are ten to twelve students in a grade. One adult stays with your child for three years. And the four people starting the school will know your child by name.

FOUNDER

Nicole Galante, Ph.D.

An educator for over twenty years. She started as a classroom teacher, coached teachers in New York City schools for more than fifteen of them, and led the state team that wrote New York's Quality Remote and Hybrid Teaching Framework and its Handbook for Virtual Schools.

LEAD GUIDE

Adam King

A musician and teacher. He designs and runs music and STEAM programs for libraries across Long Island (escape rooms, instrument labs, world percussion) and teaches private lessons. He'll know your child by Wednesday.

OPERATIONS

Gina Dimichino

For more than thirty-five years she has taught dance to North Shore kids, many of them right at this age, and she has run businesses here her whole life, including her own salon. She makes sure every family feels seen, and handles every detail in between.

ACADEMIC SYSTEMS

Izzy Galante

Designs how the school teaches: what comes first, how we know a child is ready to move on, and how we know it worked. Co-wrote New York's Quality Remote and Hybrid Teaching Framework and its Handbook for Virtual Schools. Teaches a live class every week.

We are hiring a math and science guide and a humanities guide for September 2027. You will meet them before the first day.

TWO WAYS TO COME

FIVE DAYS A WEEK

The full school.

Monday to Friday, 8:30 to 3:00. Your child can stay until 5:30 if you need it. You enroll, and that's it. There is no homeschool paperwork.

THREE DAYS A WEEK

For homeschooling families.

Monday and Wednesday, 9:15 to 12:30, and Friday, 9:15 to 2:45. We call it the Collaborative. You stay your child's teacher, and we hand you course descriptions and hours logs for your district reports.

QUESTIONS PARENTS ASK

The ones that come up first.

Is this a real school or a homeschool program?

It is a school. Your child is enrolled here five days a week, we teach every subject New York requires, and you file no homeschool paperwork. We also run a separate three-day program for families who homeschool.

How many students will there be?

Ten to twelve in a grade. Nobody is stuck in their grade, because students work at their own level across the school. On Fridays the whole school builds one thing together. It is few enough that no child gets overlooked, and enough for a real class discussion.

What does it cost?

Five days a week is $1,500 a month, $18,000 a year. Founding Families, the first families to join, pay $1,350 a month. Three days a week is $900 a month, and Founding Families pay $810. It is paid monthly over twelve months, and Founding Families keep their price through twelfth grade. Every price is two pages on.

Do students take the state tests?

Yes. The state tests are in the spring and take three mornings. We do not do test prep. New York uses the tests to check that a new school is teaching what it should. All year long you will also see how much your own child has grown, three times a year.

What about high school?

Ninth grade opens here in September 2028. Then we add a grade every year through twelfth. Your child can stay, or move on with a folder of real work that shows what they can do.

Is Soundline approved by New York?

New York does not license private schools. A private school registers with the state, and the local district reviews what it teaches. We do both. We are not accredited yet. We start that process once we are open.

How much screen time is there?

Very little. Morning math, reading and writing are hands-on, at a table with a guide. The only screen in the morning belongs to the guide. Class discussions, science lab and presentations happen without screens.

Where will the school be?

On the North Shore, along the Miller Place–Port Jefferson Station corridor. Port Jefferson Station is the likeliest. We announce the address the day we sign the lease.

What if the school doesn't open?

You get your money back. Your $500 is kept by an independent escrow agent, not by us, and it comes back in full, for any reason, until the day we sign a lease. If the school doesn't open after that, we mail you a check.

We homeschool. Can we join?

Yes. The Collaborative is three days a week: Monday and Wednesday, 9:15 to 12:30, and Friday, 9:15 to 2:45, with the same guides and the same rooms. You keep your homeschool plan, and we hand you course descriptions and hours logs to go with it. Every child who takes classes here, three days or five, has to meet New York's school immunization requirements.

Will our district bus my child?

Most likely. New York districts bus students to private schools up to fifteen miles away. You ask your own district by April 1, and we send you the request already filled in.

My child has an IEP. What happens to services?

Your child can still receive services from the public school district. You request them from the district where the school is located by June 1, and we will help you do it.

Can my child still play school sports?

New York requires students to be enrolled in the district to play on district teams, so town and club teams are the way to go. That is where most students this age already play. We have PE in the school day, and Extended Day runs until 5:30.

My child is younger, or older. Can we still talk?

Yes. A new sixth grade starts every September, and sign-up for September 2028 opens in August 2027. Write to us and we will call you before sign-up opens for your child's year. We will not have a grade for students who are in eighth grade or higher this school year.

Something we didn't answer? Write to hello@soundlineschool.com. If we don't know, we will find out and tell you.

WHAT IT COSTS

Here is what it costs, 2027–28.

Prices are per month, paid over twelve months. Founding Families are the first families to join. They pay 10% less and keep that price through twelfth grade.

	The School Five days a week, 8:30 to 3:00	The Collaborative Three days a week, for homeschooling families
Regular price, a month	**$1,500** $18,000 a year	**$900** $10,800 a year
Founding Families The first families to join. 10% off, and you keep that price through twelfth grade.	**$1,350** $16,200 a year	**$810** $9,720 a year

What's included

Everything in the school day: classes, science labs, projects, art and music. There is no materials fee.

Extended Day

After school, 3:00 to 5:30, for five-day students. It is $330 a month over twelve months, or $297 for Founding Families. You pay only if you use it.

Two kids

The second child is 10% off.

Paying in full

Pay for the whole year by March 1 and take another 3% off.

No application fee

It costs nothing to apply. Anything you pay now counts toward tuition.

Class size

Ten to twelve students in a grade. One adult stays with your child for all three years.

What you pay, and when.

There are no extra fees. Each payment counts toward the next one.

$500 holds a seat.
It is kept by an independent escrow agent, not by us. You get all of it back, for any reason, until the day we sign a lease.

$2,500 is your deposit.
It is due when you sign the enrollment contract. Your $500 counts toward it. You will know the school's address before we ask for it.

Then twelve monthly payments.
Your deposit counts toward tuition. Payments start the summer before school opens.

If the school doesn't open, your money comes back. We mail you a check.

The current prices are always at soundlineschool.com/cost.html

HOW TO START

Be one of our first families.

We are signing up our first families now. We call them Founding Families. They pay less, keep that price for as long as their child is enrolled, and help shape the school.

1

Call us.

Twenty minutes on the phone with one of the four of us. Ask anything, including about money. Write to **hello@soundlineschool.com** and we will find a time.

2

Look at the price.

Every price is on the page before this one. You see what it costs before anyone asks you for anything.

3

Hold a seat.

$500 holds your child's seat. Each grade has ten to twelve seats, and they fill in the order families reserve. We set it up with you on the call.

Founding families help shape the school.

They sit on the Family Council. The Council helps pick the projects students take on, and brings people from town into the school. It does the fun things. It never fundraises.

- Reserved seats at every student show.
- Brothers and sisters go first when a grade fills.
- A first look at each new project before it starts.
- Your family's name on the founders' wall.

DATES TO KNOW

DEC 12	Information night, Saturday. Details to follow.
JAN 14	Information night. Details to follow.
MAR 1	The last day to pay for the whole year and take 3% off.
APR 1	Your bus request to your own district is due. We send you the form already filled in.
JUN 1	If your child has an IEP, your request for services is due to the district. We help you with it.
AUG 2027	Sign-up opens for September 2028.
SEPT 2027	The first day of school.

IS YOUR CHILD YOUNGER, OR OLDER?

We open with grades 6, 7 and 8. If the timing is not right for your child, tell us, and we will call you when it is.

Younger than sixth grade. A new sixth grade starts every September. Write to us with the grade your child is in now, and we will call you before sign-up opens for their year.

High school. Ninth grade opens in September 2028, and we add a grade every year after that. We will not have a grade for students who are in eighth grade or higher this school year.

Ask for a call, or a reminder call: hello@soundlineschool.com